

allows online shopping through the PlayStation Store.

The PlayStation Network

Online multiplayer game-play is a huge part of modern video gaming. Sony had realised this trend and sought to create an interface that acts as a platform for gamers to be able to meet other gamers, keep in touch with each other, browse the iInternet and spend points and money in an online store. Thus, the PlayStation Network (PSN) was born.

The best part about PSN is that it is completely free. While Microsoft went for a paid revenue model with the Xbox Live service, Sony realised that getting users online was paramount and all revenue would be made from sales in the PlayStation Store and through advertising.



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The PSN has five main categories: Sign Up, Game, PlayStation Store, Friends and Internet Browser.

There are two types of PSN accounts: master accounts and sub accounts. Master accounts can be created by a registered user of a specified age or older, and holders can adjust settings such as monthly spending limits or restrictions on voice/video chat for associated sub accounts. Sub accounts can be used by anyone, including minors, and are monitored by the associated master account holder. Sub account holders cannot create wallets but can make use of the wallet for the associated master account to pay for products and services.

In the PlayStation Store, users can download and buy various content such as full games, add-on content, playable demos, themes and game and movie trailers. The PS Store uses real-world currency of the country that the user is in; so when you are using the Indian PSN, all your transactions will be in rupees. The amount of money you have can be controlled through the virtual 'wallet', to which you can add and delete funds.

In case online transactions scare you due to privacy concerns, PlayStation also has Network Cards available that users can buy in physical form and use the digital currency stored on them.

PlayStation Home

The idea of online avatars and social networking has really caught on with the advent of virtual worlds such as Second Life. Seeing their popularity, Sony wanted